



FOR OFFICIAL USE

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**X857/75/01****Physics**  
**Section 1 — Answer grid**  
**and Section 2**

Duration — 2 hours 30 minutes



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Fill in these boxes and read what is printed below.

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**Total marks — 135****SECTION 1 — 25 marks**

Attempt ALL questions.

Instructions for completion of Section 1 are given on *page 02*.**SECTION 2 — 110 marks**

Attempt ALL questions.

Reference may be made to the Data sheet on *page 02* of the question paper X857/75/02 and to the Relationships sheet X857/75/11.

Write your answers clearly in the spaces provided in this booklet. Additional space for answers and rough work is provided at the end of this booklet. If you use this space you must clearly identify the question number you are attempting. Any rough work must be written in this booklet. Score through your rough work when you have written your final copy.

Use **blue** or **black** ink.

Before leaving the examination room you must give this booklet to the Invigilator; if you do not, you may lose all the marks for this paper.

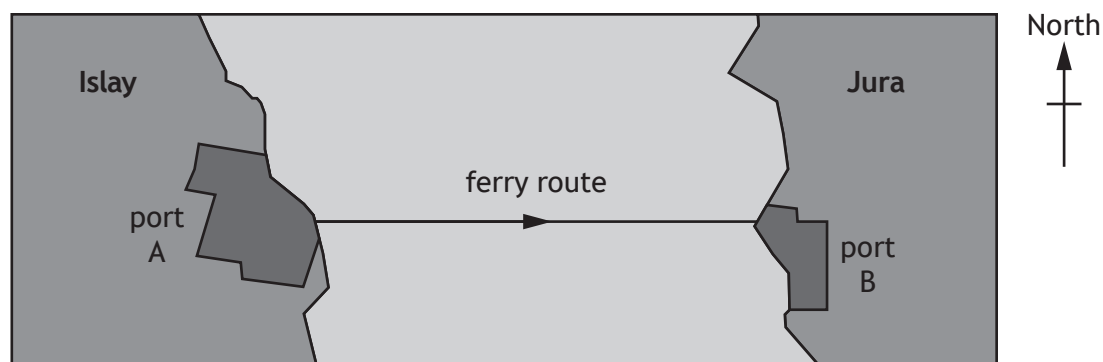


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SECTION 2 — 110 marks

Attempt ALL questions

1. A ferry makes a crossing from port A on the island of Islay to port B on the island of Jura.



Port B is 870 m due East (090) of port A.

- (a) The ferry travels directly from port A to port B at an average speed of  $2.9 \text{ m s}^{-1}$ .

- (i) Calculate the time taken for this crossing.

3

*Space for working and answer*

- (ii) State the average velocity of the ferry for this crossing.

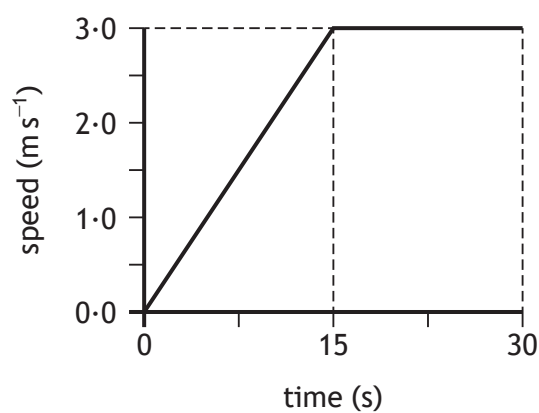
1

[Turn over



## 1. (continued)

- (b) The graph shows how the speed of the ferry varies during the first 30 s of the crossing.



- (i) Determine the acceleration of the ferry during the first 15 s of the crossing.

3

*Space for working and answer*

- (ii) Determine the distance travelled by the ferry in the first 30 s of the crossing.

3

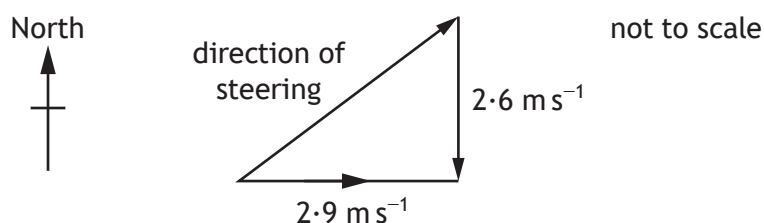
*Space for working and answer*



1. (continued)

- (c) During this crossing a strong current of  $2.6 \text{ m s}^{-1}$  flows due South (180) between the islands.

In order to complete the crossing the ferry must steer against the current as shown.



By scale diagram or otherwise, determine the direction the ferry must steer in order to travel directly between port A and B.

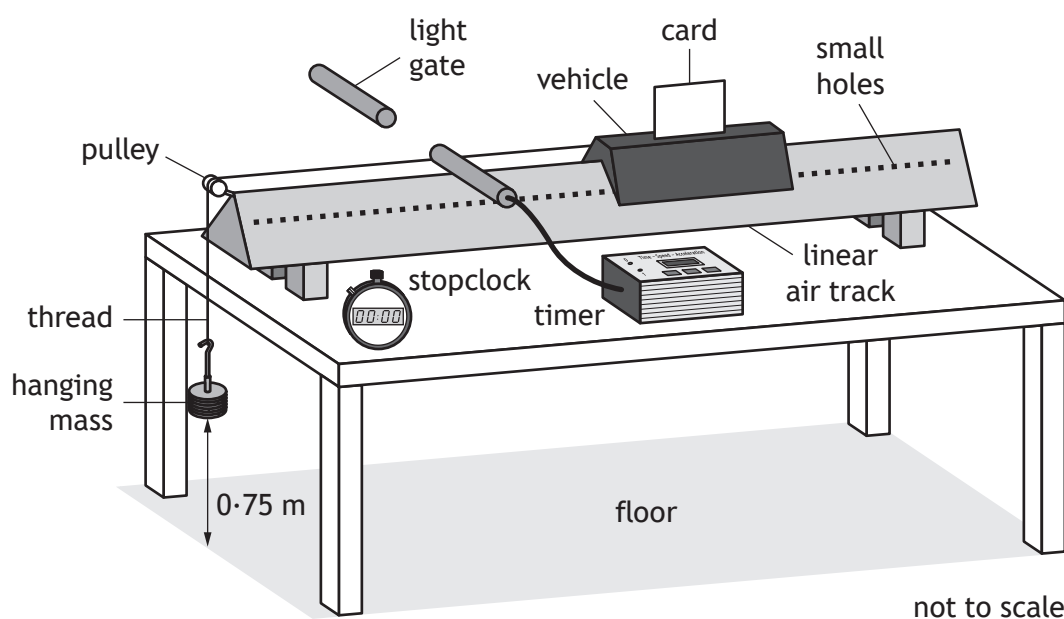
2

*Space for working and answer*

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2. A student sets up an experiment using a linear air track as shown.



A vehicle is mounted on the track.

Air is blown into the track and out through small holes in the sides of the track, causing the vehicle to be lifted slightly above the track.

The vehicle is released from rest and the card mounted on it passes through the light gate.

- (a) (i) Explain the purpose of using air to lift the vehicle slightly above the track.

1

- (ii) State the measurements the student must make in this experiment to determine the acceleration of the vehicle.

3



2. (continued)

- (b) The student carries out the experiment using a range of hanging masses.  
The results are shown in the table.

| Mass of<br>hanging mass (kg) | Weight of<br>hanging mass (N) | Acceleration of<br>vehicle ( $\text{m s}^{-2}$ ) |
|------------------------------|-------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| 0.02                         | 0.20                          | 0.40                                             |
| 0.04                         | 0.39                          | 0.79                                             |
| 0.06                         | 0.59                          | 1.21                                             |
| 0.08                         | 0.78                          | 1.80                                             |
| 0.10                         | 0.98                          | 2.01                                             |

The student identifies that one of their values of acceleration needs to be measured again.

State which value of acceleration needs to be measured again.

Justify your answer.

2

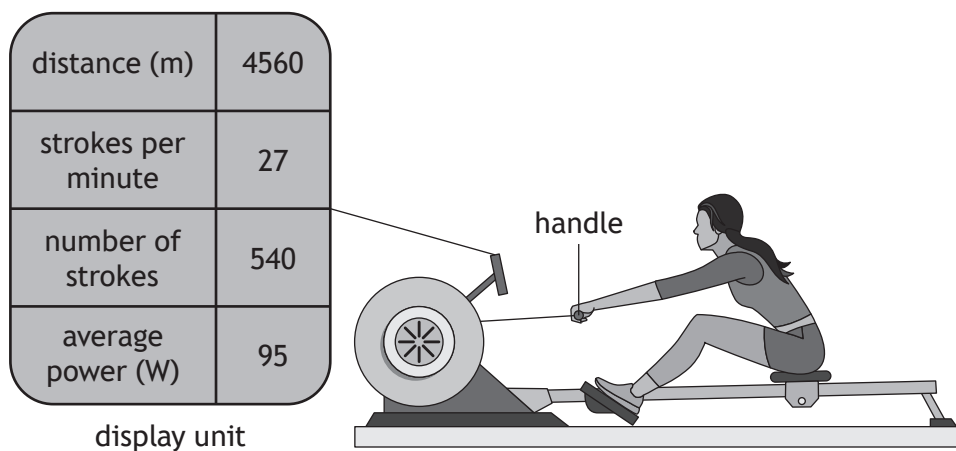
- (c) State the main energy change that takes place as the hanging mass falls to the floor.

1

[Turn over



3. An athlete is training on a rowing machine.
- Each movement back and forward on the machine is known as a stroke.
- The display unit on the machine shows data about the training session.



- (a) Show that the frequency of the strokes is 0.45 Hz.

2

*Space for working and answer*

- (b) (i) The athlete trains for 1200 s.

Calculate the energy transferred to the machine by the athlete during this time.

3

*Space for working and answer*



\* X 8 5 7 7 5 0 1 1 0 \*

3. (b) (continued)

- (ii) Explain why, during this time, the athlete produces more energy than that calculated in (b) (i).

1

- (c) During a stroke, the athlete pulls the handle backward through a distance of 1.3 m.

This movement transfers 208 J of energy to the rowing machine.

Calculate the average force exerted on the handle by the athlete during this movement.

3

*Space for working and answer*

[Turn over



\* X 8 5 7 7 5 0 1 1 1 \*



4. The table shows information about the moons of the dwarf planet Pluto.

| Name     | Mass (kg)            | Orbital period (days) | Approximate diameter (km) |
|----------|----------------------|-----------------------|---------------------------|
| Charon   | $1.6 \times 10^{21}$ | 6.39                  | 1200                      |
| Nix      | $5.0 \times 10^{16}$ | 24.9                  | 50                        |
| Hydra    | $5.0 \times 10^{16}$ | 38.2                  | 51                        |
| Kerberos | $1.6 \times 10^{16}$ | 32.2                  | 19                        |
| Styx     | $7.5 \times 10^{15}$ | 20.2                  | 16                        |

- (a) State what is meant by the term *moon*. 1
- (b) State which of these moons orbits at the greatest distance from Pluto. Justify your answer. 2
- (c) On its journey to Pluto, the space probe New Horizons passed close by the planet Jupiter. 2  
Explain how passing close to Jupiter reduced the journey time to Pluto.



\* X 8 5 7 7 5 0 1 1 2 \*

4. (continued)

- (d) After passing Jupiter, New Horizons was travelling at a speed of  $23.0 \text{ km s}^{-1}$ .

The mass of New Horizons at this time was 454 kg.

- (i) Calculate the kinetic energy of New Horizons at this time.

3

*Space for working and answer*

- (ii) New Horizons maintained this speed as it travelled on towards Pluto.

Explain, in terms of forces, why New Horizons did not have to use any fuel in order to maintain this speed.

2

- (e) When it reached Pluto, radio signals sent from New Horizons took 4.4 hours to reach Earth.

Determine the distance travelled by the signals.

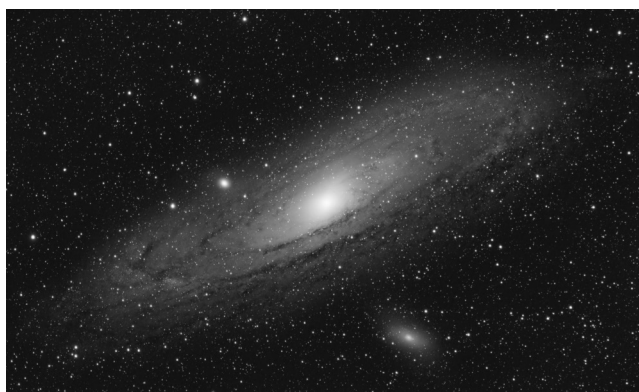
3

*Space for working and answer*



\* X 8 5 7 7 5 0 1 1 3 \*

5. The Andromeda Galaxy is more than 2 million light-years from Earth and is visible with the naked eye. However, there are many astronomical objects that are not visible with the naked eye.



Andromeda Galaxy

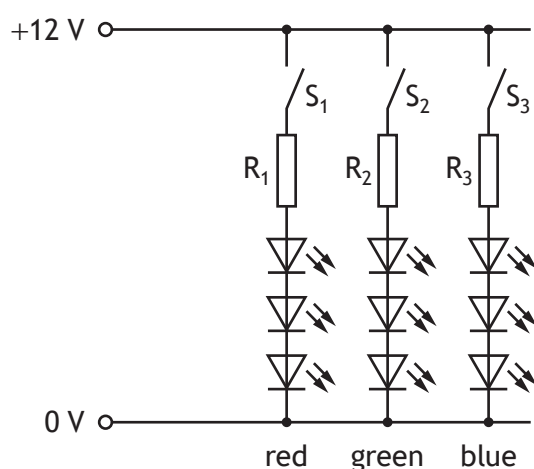
Using your knowledge of physics, comment on how astronomers obtain information about astronomical objects.

3



6. An LED strip is a long strip of plastic with red, green and blue LEDs placed at regular intervals.

The circuit for one group of LEDs is shown.



- (a) Switch  $S_1$  is closed and the red LEDs light.

Each red LED operates at a voltage of 1.8 V and a current of 0.020 A.

- (i) State the purpose of the resistor connected in series with the LEDs. 1

- (ii) Determine the resistance of resistor  $R_1$ . 4

*Space for working and answer*



6. (a) (continued)

(iii) Resistors  $R_1$ ,  $R_2$  and  $R_3$  have different resistances.

Suggest a reason why different coloured LEDs require different resistances connected in series.

1

(b) All three switches are now closed.

State whether the red LEDs will be brighter, dimmer or the same brightness compared to when only  $S_1$  is closed.

You must justify your answer.

2

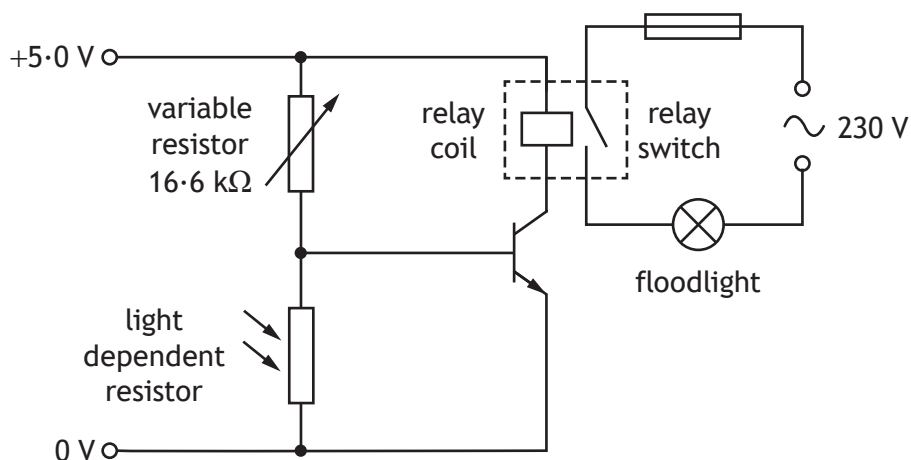
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\* X 8 5 7 7 5 0 1 1 7 \*

7. A security floodlight is used to automatically illuminate an area outside a building when it gets dark.

The circuit for this system is shown.



The resistance of the variable resistor is set to  $16.6 \text{ k}\Omega$ .

The transistor in this circuit has a switch on voltage of  $0.7 \text{ V}$ .

- (a) The light level decreases to the point where the resistance of the light dependent resistor is  $3.4 \text{ k}\Omega$ .

Show by calculation that the transistor is switched on at this light level.

3

Space for working and answer



\* X 8 5 7 7 5 0 1 1 8 \*

7. (continued)

(b) The floodlight is connected in a part of the circuit controlled by a relay.

(i) Explain why a relay is used in the circuit.

1

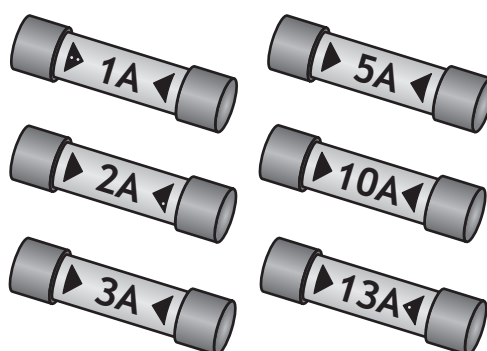
(ii) The floodlight has a power rating of 575 W.

Calculate the current in the floodlight when it is switched on.

3

*Space for working and answer*

(iii) The following fuses are available for use with the floodlight.



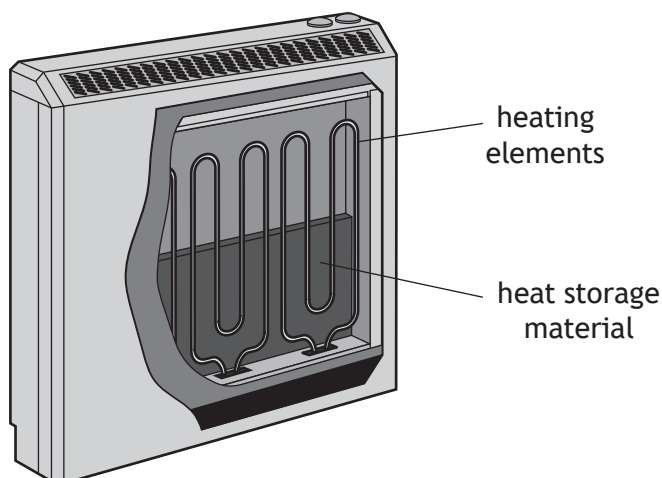
State which of these fuses is the most appropriate for use with the floodlight.

1

[Turn over



8. A storage heater heats a material overnight then allows the material to radiate this heat during the day.



A manufacturer is testing heat storage materials with different specific heat capacities.

In each test the temperature of 2.5 kg of material is raised from 22 °C to 250 °C.

- (a) One of the materials being tested by the manufacturer is clay brick.

Clay brick has a specific heat capacity of  $810 \text{ J kg}^{-1} \text{ }^{\circ}\text{C}^{-1}$ .

Calculate the minimum energy required to heat 2.5 kg of clay brick from 22 °C to 250 °C.

3

*Space for working and answer*

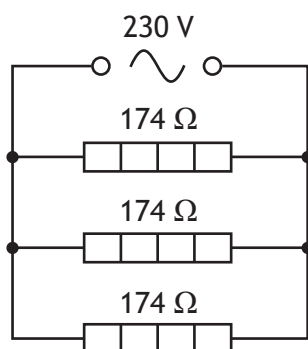




8. (continued)

MARKS  
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- (b) The circuit for the heating elements in the storage heater is shown.



- (i) Calculate the total resistance of the circuit.

3

*Space for working and answer*

- (ii) Calculate the total power developed in the circuit.

3

*Space for working and answer*

- (c) The manufacturer repeats the test using oil instead of clay brick.

State whether the time taken to heat the oil is less than, equal to or greater than the time to heat the clay brick.

Justify your answer.

2



9. A scuba diver uses compressed air from a cylinder to breathe underwater.



- (a) When the cylinder is full, the volume of compressed air in the cylinder is equivalent to 960 litres of air at a pressure of  $2.5 \times 10^5$  Pa.

The cylinder has a fixed volume of 12 litres.

Show that the pressure inside a full cylinder is  $2.0 \times 10^7$  Pa.

2

*Space for working and answer*



\* X 8 5 7 7 5 0 1 2 2 \*

9. (continued)

- (b) A full cylinder containing air at a pressure of  $2.0 \times 10^7$  Pa is stored at a temperature of  $21^\circ\text{C}$  before the dive.

When the cylinder is submerged in the water, the temperature of the air in the cylinder reduces to the temperature of the water.

This causes the pressure of the air in the full cylinder to reduce to  $1.9 \times 10^7$  Pa.

- (i) Calculate the temperature of the water.

3

*Space for working and answer*

- (ii) Using the kinetic model, explain why the pressure of the gas inside the full cylinder decreases as the temperature decreases.

3

[Turn over



\* X 8 5 7 7 5 0 1 2 3 \*

10. Electric vehicles are being promoted as an environmentally friendly method of transport.



Currently one of the limitations of electric vehicles is their range. The range is the maximum distance that an electric vehicle can travel before its batteries need to be recharged.

Using your knowledge of physics comment on possible factors affecting the range of an electric vehicle.

3

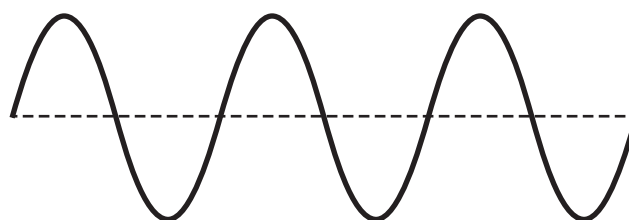


11. A student investigating sound cuts a drinking straw as shown.



- (a) The student blows through the straw to produce a sound.

A microphone is connected to an oscilloscope. The oscilloscope displays a trace of the sound wave produced by the straw as shown.



On the trace, draw **and** label

- (i) the amplitude

1

- (ii) the wavelength,  $\lambda$ .

1

(An additional diagram, if required, can be found on *page 35*.)

- (b) The sound produced has a frequency of 250 Hz.

Calculate the wavelength of the sound in air.

3

*Space for working and answer*

[Turn over



11. (continued)

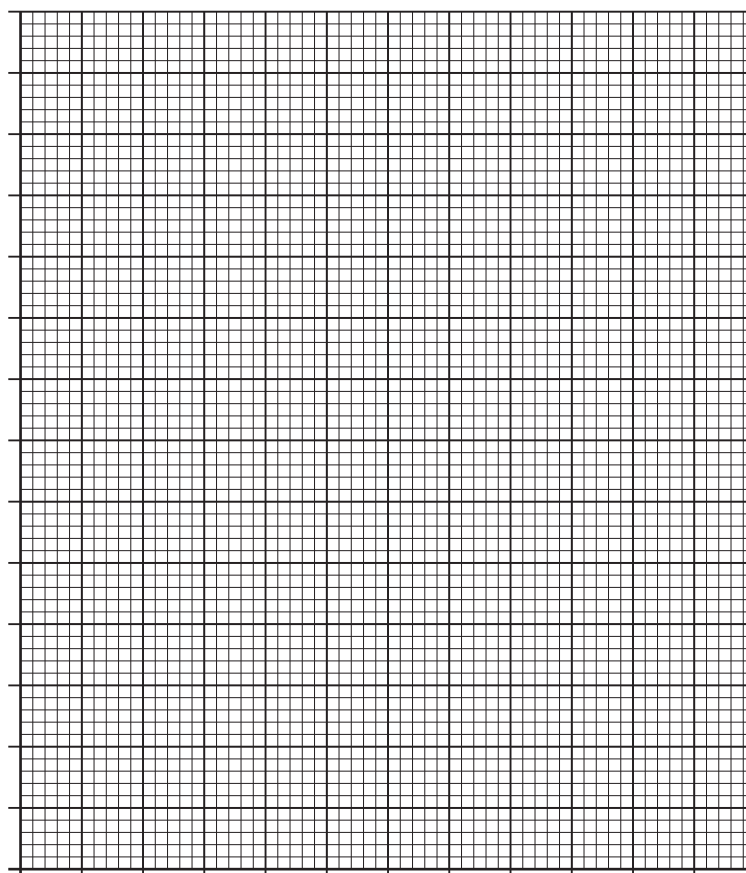
- (c) The student carries out an experiment to investigate how the length of the straw affects the frequency of the sound produced.

The results of this experiment are as shown.

| Length of straw (mm) | Frequency (Hz) |
|----------------------|----------------|
| 20                   | 1204           |
| 40                   | 597            |
| 60                   | 420            |
| 80                   | 282            |
| 100                  | 250            |

- (i) Using the graph paper below, draw a graph of these results.  
(Additional graph paper, if required, can be found on *page 35*.)

3



## 11. (c) (continued)

(ii) Use your graph to predict the frequency of sound produced by a straw that is 30 mm in length.

1

(iii) Suggest one change that could be made to improve the reliability of this experiment.

1

[Turn over]



\* X 8 5 7 7 5 0 1 2 9 \*

12. A scientist studying human genetics uses a technique involving a radioactive tracer called a DNA probe.

The DNA probe allows the scientist to identify if a particular section of DNA is present within a sample of tissue.

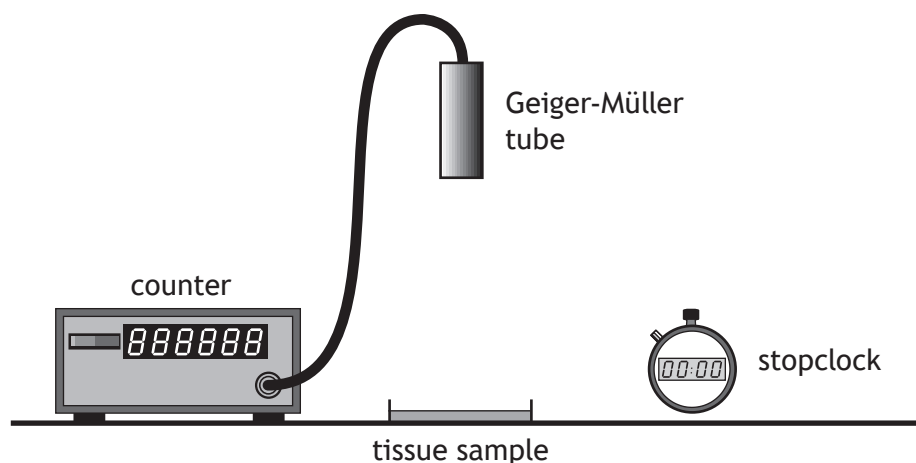
- (a) The scientist prepares a solution containing the DNA probe and labels it as shown.

| DNA Probe Solution                  |
|-------------------------------------|
| Date prepared: Monday 20 April 2020 |
| Half-life: 22 hours                 |
| Radiation emitted: Beta particles   |

Suggest why this solution would be unsuitable to use one week after it was prepared.

1

- (b) The scientist uses the equipment shown to test a tissue sample to identify if the DNA probe is present.



The average background count rate is 18 counts per minute.





12. (b) (continued)

(i) State a source of background radiation.

1

(ii) The tissue sample has an activity of 5.5 Bq.

Calculate the number of decays that occur in this sample each minute.

3

*Space for working and answer*

(iii) In practice, the number of decays per minute detected by the Geiger-Müller tube is much less than the number of decays calculated in (b) (ii).

This makes it difficult to distinguish the count rate due to the DNA probe from that due to background radiation.

Suggest one change to the set up that would increase the number of decays per minute detected by the Geiger-Müller tube due to the DNA probe in this sample.

1

[Turn over



\* X 8 5 7 7 5 0 1 3 1 \*

13. In a nuclear power station, nuclear reactions are used to generate electrical energy.



- (a) In a nuclear reaction a uranium nucleus is split by a neutron to produce two smaller nuclei, two or three neutrons and energy.

(i) State the name given to this type of nuclear reaction.

1

- (ii) Explain how a single reaction can lead to the continuous generation of energy.

2



\* X 8 5 7 7 5 0 1 3 2 \*

13. (continued)

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- (b) The waste products from nuclear power stations are radioactive and need to be stored until their activity reaches a safe level.

One type of waste has a half-life of 32 years.

Determine the time taken for the activity of this waste to decrease to one eighth of its original value.

3

*Space for working and answer*

- (c) During a typical shift, a worker handling radioactive material receives an absorbed dose of  $2.2 \mu\text{Gy}$  from slow neutrons and  $3.4 \mu\text{Gy}$  from gamma radiation.

- (i) Determine the total equivalent dose received by the worker during a typical shift.

4

*Space for working and answer*

- (ii) The annual dose limit for a radiation worker is 20 mSv.

Determine the number of typical shifts that it would take for the worker to receive a dose of 20 mSv.

2

*Space for working and answer*

[END OF QUESTION PAPER]



\* X 8 5 7 7 5 0 1 3 3 \*

